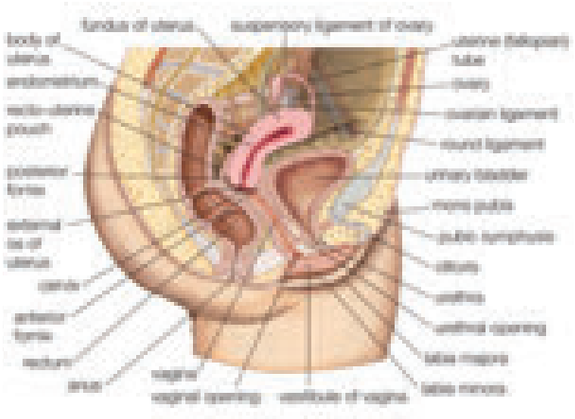


Female Reproductive System

Female reproductive system

The female reproductive system is made up of the internal and external sex organs that function in reproduction of new offspring. The female reproductive system is immature at birth and develops to maturity at puberty and able to produce gametes, and to carry a foetus to full term.

Parts of Female Reproductive System.

External Organs	Internal Organs
• Vulva • Mons pubis • labia majora • Labia minora • clitoris • Vestibule	• Vagina • Cervix • Uterus • Fallopian tubes • Ovaries

External Organs

Vulva

The vulva is the external part of the female genitalia. It protects the woman's sexual organs urethra, vestibule, and vagina.

Mons Pubis

The mons pubis is a pad of fat lying in front of the symphysis pubis where pubic hair develops with puberty.

Labia majora

The labia majora are two thick folds which form the sides of the vulva.

Labia minora

The labia minora lies just inside the labia majora and surround the openings to the vagina and urethra.

The Clitoris

The clitoris lies above the vagina is covered with a protective cover or hood.

Vestibule

It is a small space or cavity at the beginning of a vaginal canal.

Internal Organs

Vagina

The Vagina is an elastic, muscular canal that extends from the vulva to the cervix. The vaginal canal travels upwards and backwards between the urethra at the front and the rectum at the back.

The outer vaginal opening is normally partly covered by a membrane called the hymen. It joins the internal and external female reproductive organs and protects against infection by a moist secretion.

Cervix

The cervix is the lower part of the uterus. The lower narrow portion where it joins with the upper part of the vagina. The cervix is usually 2-3 cm long and roughly cylindrical in shape which changes during pregnancy. As labour progresses, the cervix becomes softer and shorter, beings to dilate and facilitate normal labour.

Uterus

The uterus is a pear shaped muscular organ and the major female reproductive organ. It provides mechanical protection, nutritional support, and removal of the waste for developing embryo and fetus.

- It has three layers, they are perimetrium, myometrium and endometrium.

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